

UNSCRIPTED SMALL BUSINESS · PODCAST



Design Your Life on Purpose

Ameera Virani on habits, visibility & wealth

Host: Jeremy Rivera · Guest: Ameera Virani, The Designed Life

Watch: youtu.be/sdFOz3ZPeIY Listen: unscripted-small-business.castos.com ameeravirani.com

WHAT'S INSIDE

The Designed Life, in eight ideas

A NOTE FROM JEREMY

Jeremy here. I automate things so founders can get their hours back — but hours only matter if you know where they should go. This little book distills my conversation with Ameera Virani into the ideas I keep thinking about.

- 01** Designing a life on purpose
- 02** The patterns we repeat
- 03** Habit stacking and the morning phone
- 04** Are we dogs? Pain, pleasure, and the internal thermostat
- 05** The myth of balance, the honesty of harmony
- 06** The time audit
- 07** The deepest struggle: being fully seen
- 08** Small steps, not a teardown

CHAPTER 01

Designing a life on purpose

Ameera Virani defines “the designed life” as intentionally choosing how you live across five foundational pillars — health and wellness, business or career, wealth, fulfillment and joy, and relationships. It is not a vision board; it is a decision, renewed daily.

Her process begins with clarity. She helps women get exceptionally clear on what they truly desire in their current season, aligns that with their values, checks it against the beliefs they carry, and then maps a blueprint to bring the design to life.

CHAPTER 02

The patterns we repeat

The most common pitfall Ameera sees — especially in midlife women wanting something different — is deviating back to the familiar from a subconscious layer. We are, she says, creatures of habit.

“We tend to do the same things over and over again, but then we expect a different result and wonder why we're not getting that.”

— Ameera Virani

The work is to surface those loops and interrupt them: to notice the patterns producing results you no longer want, and to ask better questions that lead somewhere new.

CHAPTER 03

Habit stacking and the morning phone

Her most concrete tool is habit stacking. If your first act each morning is to grab the phone and fall into email, but what you actually want is time freedom and less anxiety, the fix is physical: move the phone out of the room so the instinct has nothing to grab.

Then stack the habit of the person who already has what you want — thirty minutes to move, meditate, or set intentions — and let checking the phone become the fifth or sixth thing you do, not the first.

CHAPTER 04

Are we dogs? Pain, pleasure, and the internal thermostat

We are wired to avoid pain more than to chase pleasure, Ameera explains, so we wait until circumstances are dire before we change. And when success climbs past anything familiar, the nervous system reads it as unsafe and pulls us back — what she calls the internal thermostat.

“It's not just in the doing, it's actually in the becoming of someone who can hold the type of change and success that you desire to have.”

— Ameera Virani

The way through is layered. It is not only new action; it is becoming the kind of person who can hold the new normal without snapping back.

CHAPTER 05

The myth of balance, the honesty of harmony

Ameera calls work-life balance a bit of a myth we've been sold. Balance implies two separate lives, and technology dissolved that line the moment work started traveling in our pockets.

She offers harmony instead — a rhythm that flexes with the season. For founders especially, some seasons demand more and others give time back, and pretending otherwise only adds guilt.

CHAPTER 06

The time audit

On time, Ameera is blunt, and her line is the one people remember. Her antidote is a time audit: put your week on paper and see, honestly, where the hours go — scrolling, shopping, sleep, family.

“No one ever looked back on their deathbed and said, I wish I had spent more time at work.”

— Ameera Virani

Then come the operator's questions: what can be automated, what can be delegated, and what can simply be set aside so your time flows to the people and the work that matter most.

CHAPTER 07

The deepest struggle: being fully seen

Beneath the tactics is the block Ameera returns to — the fear of being fully seen. Not stages or social media, but being known as who you truly are and what you're here to do.

“Being fully seen as who you are and what it is you are truly here to do.”

— Ameera Virani

It is why capable people stay in the version of themselves that is comfortable for everyone else, and why so many women, devoted to the people in their lives, will quietly surrender their own voice to keep the peace.

CHAPTER 08

Small steps, not a teardown

Ameera never advocates burning it all down. The women she works with have built beautiful lives and earned them through real sacrifice.

“It's never about changing everything, but it is about taking those small steps forward towards the life that you desire to live.”

— Ameera Virani

The invitation is gentler and harder at once: not to change everything, but to take the next small step toward the life you actually want. Evolution and elevation — not demolition.

IDEAS WORTH STEALING

Six to take with you

- 01 Get exceptionally clear on what you truly desire — then design your life around it.
- 02 Interrupt the pattern; stack one better habit at the trigger point.
- 03 Expect the internal thermostat and build safety habit by habit.
- 04 Trade balance for harmony that flexes with your season.
- 05 Run a time audit and guard the moments that won't come again.
- 06 Name and move through the fear of being fully seen — in small steps.

GO DEEPER

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